Northfield Systems Assurance Ltd
14 Castlegate, Sheffield S1 2GH, United Kingdom

Sheffield, 15 June 2026

TECHNICAL NOTE - PROJECT COMPASS GENERAL LEDGER INCIDENT

1. Instructions

I, Ian Castellan, was instructed by Marchmont Dynamics Ltd to review the technical cause of the General Ledger incident of 29-30 November 2025, including the report of Dr. Elena Marti of Bantiger IT Forensics AG dated 25 February 2026.

2. Comments on Dr. Marti's Report

I agree with Dr. Marti that the proximate trigger of the duplicate postings was the replay of a migrated journal batch without an idempotency safeguard. I disagree, however, with the weight her report gives to that single factor. The migrated batch in question originated from the legacy data extract delivered by the Client only on 6 October 2025, some three weeks after the contractual Data Freeze Date, which left materially less time for data-quality testing than the Statement of Work envisaged.

3. Response Time

I note that Marchmont's lead consultant, Fox, identified the cause of the defect within approximately fifteen minutes of its first appearance and had a tested patch deployed within roughly twenty hours, which in my professional experience is a materially faster response than is typical for a defect of this severity.

4. Conclusion

In my opinion, the delay in supplying usable legacy data was a significant contributing cause of the incident, alongside the absence of an idempotency safeguard, and the two causes cannot properly be separated when assessing responsibility.

Ian Castellan

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